

Decory Edwards
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Economics

December 24, 2025

Hiring Committee
Matters Graph LP
Washington, DC

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Associate position in the Washington DC office at Matters Graph. I am currently a PhD candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University. My training combines rigorous analytical reasoning, structured quantitative analysis, and evidence based research. I am motivated by problems that require careful framing, disciplined investigation, and clear conclusions under real world constraints. Matters Graph's focus on pressure testing investment theses and delivering evidence driven strategic advice strongly aligns with how I approach research and analysis.

My research agenda is at the intersection of wealth inequality and macroeconomics. In my job market paper, I build and estimate a structural heterogeneous agent model with returns that differ across households. The core contribution is to show how heterogeneity in returns and income risk jointly shape the wealth distribution and consumption behavior. Relative to closely related work, my framework performs better at matching the lower and middle portions of the wealth distribution. This difference matters quantitatively. Models that focus primarily on returns heterogeneity can fit the top of the wealth distribution closely but tend to generate too much wealth among the bottom half of households. In my framework, income uncertainty generates a precautionary saving motive that produces genuinely low wealth households. This leads to a realistic distribution of marginal propensities to consume and aggregate consumption responses that align with empirical estimates.

A key feature of my research is the use of primary data analysis and structured modeling to answer applied questions. I design research strategies, identify appropriate data sources, and conduct both quantitative and qualitative analysis. I work with large datasets, construct variables from raw information, and synthesize results into clear written narratives. This work requires precision, strong judgment, and the ability to translate complex analysis into practical conclusions, skills that map directly to commercial due diligence and strategy engagements.

I am particularly interested in Matters Graph because of its emphasis on evidence based advice and its close work with private equity and corporate decision makers. The opportunity to serve as a core member of small case teams and contribute meaningfully to live client engagements is especially appealing. I value environments that reward intellectual curiosity, high standards, and ownership of work. Matters Graph's entrepreneurial culture and commitment to developing consultants over the long term resonate strongly with my professional goals.

My economics training has provided a strong foundation in quantitative reasoning, qualitative assessment, and clear communication. I am comfortable producing written presentations in Word and PowerPoint and explaining analytical results to non technical audiences. I work well in team

settings and take feedback seriously as part of continuous improvement. These skills are central to my research process and would be directly applicable in a consulting role.

I am also enthusiastic about the prospect of living and working in Washington DC. I value in person collaboration and the exposure to clients operating at the intersection of business, government, and regulated industries. I see this role as an opportunity to apply my analytical training in a demanding consulting environment while building a long term career.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills and perspective to Matters Graph. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards